

BOE Costing Portal

User Guide

How to upload a Bill of Entry, read its landed costing, and model what-if scenarios against it.

Source: docs/USER-GUIDE.md

Look up any import record by reference, see what each item actually cost to land, and model what-if scenarios against it.

Everything on screen is derived from the Bill of Entry itself. You upload the ICEGATE PDF once; the portal reads it and does the rest.

Getting in

<https://boe-costing-portal.vercel.app>

Sign in with **Continue with Google**. There is no separate password to remember, and no account to create.

Access is granted address by address. If you have not been added yet, Google will let you sign in and the portal will then tell you that you are not permitted — that is not a fault, it means an administrator has to add your address first. Ask, then sign in again.

The three screens

SCREEN	WHAT IT IS FOR
Import records (home)	every BOE on file, filterable and sortable
Record	one BOE: its shipment facts, its actual landed costing, its licences and documents
Simulate	what-if scenarios costed against that record, side by side

1. Uploading a Bill of Entry

From the records list, choose **+ Upload BOE**, then drag the ICEGATE PDF onto the panel or click to browse. PDF only.

Reading takes a few seconds — a long BOE with several invoices takes longer. When it finishes you are told the BE number and how many items and licence rows were saved, with a button to open the record.

Re-uploading the same BOE is safe. Its items and licences are replaced, not duplicated. This is how you pick up a parser improvement on a record that was imported earlier: parsing happens at upload, so a stored record keeps whatever was read at the time.

Two things worth knowing:

- Figures you have **confirmed** as actual are never overwritten by a re-upload. Anything still marked provisional is brought in line with the new parse.
- If the upload fails with *could not reach the parser service*, the reader service is down rather than the file being bad. Running locally, start it and try again; on the deployed site there is nothing for you to start — a very large or scanned PDF is the usual cause.

2. Finding a record

The records list shows supplier, BOE number, date and invoice value, ten rows to a page, newest first.

- Filter** in the row of boxes under the headings: supplier name and BOE number match on any part of the text; date and value are ranges, and you can fill in just one end. Filters combine.

- **Sort** by clicking any column heading; click again to reverse it. Records with no date sort last either way.
- **Clear filters** appears once any filter is set, and the count above the table reads *n records of m*, so you always know how much is hidden.

Click a row to open the record.

3. Reading a record

The six tiles across the top are the headline figures: exchange rate, invoice value, freight, other expenses, duty in cost, and average cost per piece with the total quantity beneath it.

Green means confirmed, red means provisional. Exchange rate and freight are the two figures routinely estimated at costing time that settle later, so each carries its status. Red is not an error — it means nobody has yet confirmed that number is the one finally paid. Silence is not confirmation, so anything never marked as actual reads as provisional.

Below the tiles:

- **Shipment** — supplier, invoice number and date, BE date, AWB / HAWB, importer.
- **Actual costing** — one row per item, with quantity, rate, freight prorata, duty in cost, expenses, landed total and cost per piece, totalled at the foot. Freight is its own column rather than folded into expenses, so freight impact is readable on its own.
- **Licences** — the licence rows the item duty was debited against, with the total debited in the heading. Shown only when the BOE has them.
- **Documents** — the BOE PDF and any supporting files. Links are signed and expire an hour after the page loads; reload the page to renew them.

View BOE PDF opens the source document every figure was read from — reach for it whenever a number looks wrong.

Download Excel gives you the C-SHEET workbook with live formulas.

What "duty in cost" includes

BCD and SWS. **IGST is deliberately excluded**: it is a creditable input tax, so it is cash flow rather than cost. It is still reported separately.

Expenses are apportioned by value, not spread evenly: each item takes a share of one expense pool in proportion to its declared value. Change any expense and every item's slice moves in proportion.

4. Running a simulation

Open a record and choose **Simulate costing**.

A new scenario **starts as an exact copy of the actual costing** — every input is empty, and empty means *inherit the actual*. Only what you deliberately change moves a number, so any difference you see is a difference you made.

1. Create. Choose + **New simulation**. The inputs panel opens on the left.

2. Set the inputs. The tables update as you type.

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Name, Notes	how the scenario is labelled everywhere, and what it is testing
Duty: Fixed (default)	duty stays at exactly what customs charged, whatever else changes
Duty: Float with value	duty is recomputed from this BOE's effective rates, so a price or exchange-rate change moves it too
Exchange rate	INR per USD
Freight mode	Air / Sea / Road / Courier / Other — a label only; it changes no figure
Freight basis	lump sum, or per kg / per CBM / per container

CONTROL	WHAT IT DOES
Freight rate × quantity	fill in both and the total is computed for you and overrides the typed total; fill in one and your typed total still stands
Other expenses	insurance, clearance, misc (freight 2), supplier freight, bank charges, own bank charges, others
Margin %	feeds the selling-price columns of the Excel export; it is not shown in the on-screen tables

The green / red tick under exchange rate and freight marks that figure as a confirmed actual rather than the provisional one carried over from the BOE.

3. Adjust individual items in the *Item adjustments* table. An empty price or quantity box shows the actual as its placeholder, so an untouched row still reads as the number it will use.

- **Rate / Qty** — type over either to override just that item.
- **FOC** — marks an item free of charge. Its declared value stays in the apportionment base, because the goods still ship and are still assessed, so freight does not shift onto the paid items. A second tick decides whether duty still applies to it.
- **Duplicate** — adds an extra row that exists only in this scenario, with its own description, price and quantity. Its duty always derives from the row it was copied from, even when duty is fixed: locking a copy to the original's amounts would charge the same customs payment twice.
- **Reset** — drops your overrides on that row and returns it to the actual.

4. Save. An amber dot on the tab and an *unsaved* badge mark changes not yet stored. Unsaved changes still appear in every table and comparison, so what you compare is always what is on screen. **Close inputs** folds the panel away and keeps your changes; **Save** stores them. Editing a saved scenario overwrites it — scenarios do not keep a version history.

5. Compare. The strip at the top shows the scenario against the actual: average cost per piece, landed total, exchange rate, freight prorata, duty in cost, expenses and goods payable, each with its change. Red is more expensive, green is cheaper. The **All scenarios** table at the foot lists the actual and every scenario together.

Duplicate copies a whole scenario as the starting point for the next variant. **Delete** removes it, and asks first.

If a scenario says "duty locked"

An item with no assessable value on record has nothing to back-compute a duty rate from. Rather than report nil duty, the portal holds that item at its actual duty and tells you how many items are affected.

5. Exporting

Download Excel on a record gives the actual costing as the C-SHEET workbook. The same button on a simulation gives that scenario in **the same workbook, the same layout, the same live formulas** — with a red banner naming the scenario, so a what-if can never be mistaken for the actual record.

6. If a figure looks wrong

1. Open **View BOE PDF** and check the figure on the form. Everything on the record was read from it.
2. Check whether the figure is marked **provisional** — it may simply not have been confirmed yet.
3. If the parser misread the form, re-upload the BOE once the fix is in; a fix does not reach records already stored.
4. Costs read slightly higher than the old spreadsheet on some BOEs. That is expected, and it is a fix: misc charges, supplier freight, bank charges and own bank charges were captured and displayed by the spreadsheet but left out of its cost-per-piece formula. All four are in the pool here.